

Dear Math 142 Students,

- This package contains solution keys for your assignments 1 — 6.
- It also contains some solutions to other interesting problems.
- I hope it will be useful for your review for the Midterm I.

With my Care,
W. Gu

Chapter 1 Curves

Prof. Gu

1-2 Parametrized Curve

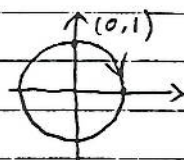
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#1 Let $\alpha(t) = (\sin t, \cos t)$, then

$$x^2(t) + y^2(t) = \sin^2 t + \cos^2 t = 1$$

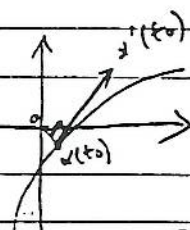
$$\alpha(0) = (0, 1)$$

Q.E.D



#2 Let $l(t) = \|\alpha(t)\|^2$

To minimize $l(t)$ is equivalent to minimize $\|\alpha(t)\|$.



Since $l(t)$ achieves its minimum at t_0 , then $l'(t_0)$ must equal to zero.

$$\text{Now } l(t) = \alpha(t) \cdot \alpha(t)$$

$$l'(t) = \alpha'(t) \cdot \alpha(t) + \alpha(t) \cdot \alpha'(t) = 2\alpha'(t) \cdot \alpha(t)$$

$$\Rightarrow l'(t_0) = 2\alpha'(t_0) \cdot \alpha(t_0) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(t_0) \cdot \alpha(t_0) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(t_0) \perp \alpha(t_0)$$

Q.E.D

#3 Suppose $t \in (a, b)$, then $\alpha(t)$ is a line segment where $t \in (a, b)$.

Pf: $\alpha''(t) = 0$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(t) = \underline{a} \text{ (constant)}$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha(t) = \underline{a}t + \underline{b} \text{ (constant)}$$

Q.E.D

#4 Let $\alpha(t) = (x(t), y(t), z(t))$, $t \in I$, $0 \in I$

$$\alpha'(t) = (x'(t), y'(t), z'(t)), \quad V = (a, b, c)$$

$$\text{Now } \alpha'(t) \cdot V = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a x'(t) + b y'(t) + c z'(t) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a \int_0^t x'(t) dt + b \int_0^t y'(t) dt + c \int_0^t z'(t) dt = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a x(t) \Big|_0^t + b y(t) \Big|_0^t + c z(t) \Big|_0^t = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a x(t) + b y(t) + c z(t) - a x(0) - b y(0) - c z(0) = 0 \Rightarrow \alpha(t) \cdot V - \alpha(0) \cdot V = 0$$

$\alpha(t) \cdot V$



$$\alpha'(t) \cdot V = 0$$



0

#5 Suppose $|\alpha(t)|$ is nonzero constant.

$$\Rightarrow |\alpha(t)|^2 = c \text{ (constant)}$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha(t) \cdot \alpha(t) = c$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(t) \cdot \alpha(t) + \alpha(t) \cdot \alpha'(t) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 2\alpha'(t) \cdot \alpha(t) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(t) \perp \alpha(t)$$

Conversely, suppose $\alpha(t) \perp \alpha'(t)$. Let $\alpha(t) = (x(t), y(t), z(t))$

$$\text{Then } x(t)x'(t) + y(t)y'(t) + z(t)z'(t) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \int_{t_0}^t x(t)x'(t)dt + \int_{t_0}^t y(t)y'(t)dt + \int_{t_0}^t z(t)z'(t)dt = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \int_{t_0}^t x(t)dx(t) + \int_{t_0}^t y(t)dy(t) + \int_{t_0}^t z(t)dz(t) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{x^2(t)}{2} + \frac{y^2(t)}{2} + \frac{z^2(t)}{2} = \frac{x^2(t_0)}{2} + \frac{y^2(t_0)}{2} + \frac{z^2(t_0)}{2}$$

$$\text{Let } A = x^2(t_0) + y^2(t_0) + z^2(t_0) \text{ (a constant)}$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2(t) + y^2(t) + z^2(t) = A$$

$$\Rightarrow |\alpha(t)|^2 = A \Rightarrow |\alpha(t)| = \sqrt{A}$$

Q.E.D

2. A circular disk of radius 1 in the plane xy rolls without slipping along the x axis. The figure described by a point of the circumference of the disk is called a *cycloid* (Fig. 1-7).

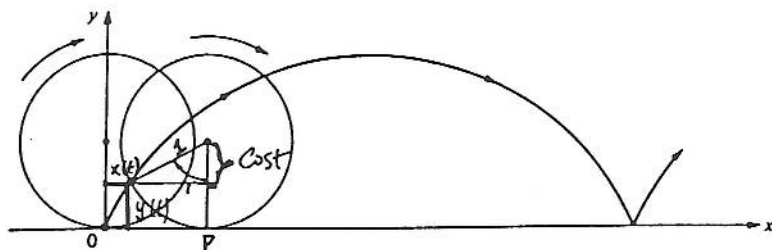


Figure 1-7. The cycloid.

- *a. Obtain a parametrized curve $\alpha: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ the trace of which is the cycloid, and determine its singular points.
 b. Compute the arc length of the cycloid corresponding to a complete rotation of the disk.

a) Let's first calculate op .

Since $l = r \cdot t = 1 \cdot t = t$ and the disk rolls without slipping so we have $op = l = t$

$$\Rightarrow x(t) = t - \sin t$$

$$\text{clearly } y(t) = 1 - \cos t$$

thus $\alpha(t) = (t - \sin t, 1 - \cos t)$. Singular points: $t = 2\pi k, k \in \mathbb{Z}$

$$b) \int_0^{2\pi} |\alpha'(t)| dt = \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{(1 - \cos t)^2 + (\sin t)^2} dt$$

$$= \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{2(1 - \cos t)} dt = \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{4 \sin^2 \frac{t}{2}} dt \stackrel{\substack{\sin \frac{t}{2} \geq 0 \\ \text{over } [0, 2\pi]}}{=} \int_0^{2\pi} 2 \sin \frac{t}{2} dt$$

$$= -4 \cos \frac{t}{2} \Big|_0^{2\pi} = -(0 - 4) = 4$$

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3. Let $OA = 2a$ be the diameter of a circle S^1 and OY and AV be the tangents to S^1 at O and A , respectively. A half-line r is drawn from O which meets the circle S^1 at C and the line AV at B . On OB mark off the segment $Op = CB$. If we rotate r about O , the point p will describe a curve called the *cisoid of Diocles*. By taking OA as the x axis and OY as the y axis, prove that

a. The trace of

$$\alpha(t) = \left(\frac{2at^2}{1+t^2}, \frac{2at^3}{1+t^2} \right), \quad t \in \mathbb{R},$$

is the cisoid of Diocles ($t = \tan \theta$; see Fig. 1-8).

b. The origin $(0, 0)$ is a singular point of the cisoid.

c. As $t \rightarrow \infty$, $\alpha(t)$ approaches the line $x = 2a$, and $\alpha'(t) \rightarrow (0, 2a)$. Thus, as $t \rightarrow \infty$, the curve and its tangent approach the line $x = 2a$; we say that $x = 2a$ is an *asymptote* to the cisoid.

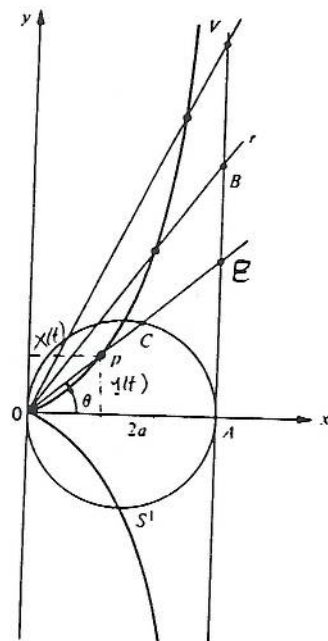


Figure 1-8. The cisoid of Diocles.

a) Let's first find the coordinates for B:

$$\frac{y}{2a} = \tan \theta \Rightarrow y = 2a \tan \theta$$

and x is clearly $2a$

$$\Rightarrow B: (2a, 2a \tan \theta)$$

Next, let's compute the coordinate for C:

Since the circle has equation $(x-a)^2 + y^2 = a^2$, the line pass OB is $y = (\tan \theta)x$, thus their intersection is a solution to

$$(x-a)^2 + (\tan \theta)x^2 = a^2$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 - 2ax + a^2 + (\tan \theta)^2 x^2 = a^2$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 (1 + \tan^2 \theta) - 2ax = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 \sec^2 \theta - 2ax = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x(x \sec^2 \theta - 2a) = 0 \Rightarrow x = 0 \text{ or } x = \frac{2a}{\sec^2 \theta} = 2a \cos^2 \theta$$

$$\text{thus } C: (2a \cos^2 \theta, 2a \cos^2 \theta \tan \theta)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Now } \vec{Op} &= \vec{OB} - \vec{OC} = (2a - 2a \cos^2 \theta, 2a \tan \theta - 2a \cos^2 \theta \tan \theta) \\ &= (2a \sin^2 \theta, 2a \tan \theta \sin^2 \theta) \end{aligned}$$

Let $t = \tan \theta$

$$\text{Now } \frac{t^2}{1+t^2} = \frac{\tan^2 \theta}{1+\tan^2 \theta} = \frac{\tan^2 \theta}{\sec^2 \theta} = \frac{\frac{\sin^2 \theta}{\cos^2 \theta}}{\frac{1}{\cos^2 \theta}} = \sin^2 \theta$$

$$\text{Thus } \vec{OP} = \left(\frac{2at^2}{1+t^2}, \frac{2at^3}{1+t^2} \right)$$

Another way to show a) is by using polar coordinates:

$$\text{Since the circle is } (x-a)^2 + y^2 = a^2 \implies \begin{aligned} x &= a \cos \varphi + a \\ y &= a \sin \varphi \end{aligned}$$

Note when φ run from 0 to π , θ is from 0 to $\frac{\pi}{2}$
Thus here $\varphi = 2\theta$.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Now the length of OC is } r_c &= \sqrt{(a \cos 2\theta + a)^2 + (a \sin 2\theta)^2} \\ &= a^2 \sqrt{\cos^2 2\theta + 2 \cos 2\theta + 1 + \sin^2 2\theta} \\ &= a^2 \sqrt{2(1 + \cos 2\theta)} \\ &= a^2 \sqrt{4 \cos^2 \theta} = 2a \cos \theta \end{aligned}$$

Now since the line is $x = 2a \implies r \cos \theta = 2a \implies r = 2a \sec \theta$

The length of OB is $r_B = 2a \sec \theta$

Now the length of OP is $r_p = r_B - r_c = 2a \sec \theta - 2a \cos \theta$

Now, the coordinates of P is $(r_p \cos \theta, r_p \sin \theta)$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \left(\left(2a \frac{1}{\cos \theta} - 2a \cos \theta \right) \cos \theta, \left(2a \frac{1}{\cos \theta} - 2a \cos \theta \right) \sin \theta \right) \\ &= (2a(1 - \cos^2 \theta), 2a \tan \theta - 2a \tan \theta \cos^2 \theta) \\ &= (2a \sin^2 \theta, 2a \tan \theta \sin^2 \theta) \text{ same as } (*) \end{aligned}$$

$$3b) \alpha(t) = \left(\frac{2at^2}{1+t^2}, \frac{2at^3}{1+t^2} \right)$$

$$\alpha'(t) = \left(\frac{4at(1+t^2) - 2t(2at^2)}{(1+t^2)^2}, \frac{6at^2(1+t^2) - 2t(2at^3)}{(1+t^2)^2} \right)$$

$$= \left(\frac{4at}{(1+t^2)^2}, \frac{6at^2 + 2at^4}{(1+t^2)^2} \right)$$

$$= \left(\frac{4at}{(1+t^2)^2}, \frac{2at^2(3+t^2)}{(1+t^2)^2} \right)$$

$$\begin{cases} 4at = 0 \\ 2at^2(3+t^2) = 0 \end{cases} \xrightarrow{a \neq 0} t = 0 \Rightarrow \alpha(0) = (0, 0)$$

Thus the origin $(0, 0)$ is a singular pt of the crossoid.

$$3c) \text{ as } t \rightarrow \infty \quad y(t) = \frac{2at^3}{1+t^2} \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} \infty$$

$$x(t) = \frac{2at^2}{1+t^2} = \frac{2a(1+t^2) - 2a}{1+t^2} = 2a - \frac{2a}{1+t^2} \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} 2a$$

Thus as $t \rightarrow \infty$, $\alpha(t)$ approaches to the line $x = 2a$.

$$\text{By 3b), } \alpha'(t) = \left(\frac{4at}{(1+t^2)^2}, \frac{6at^2 + 2at^4}{(1+t^2)^2} \right) \longrightarrow (0, 2a)$$

$$\text{i.e. } \frac{y(t)}{x(t)} \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} \infty$$

Thus, as $t \rightarrow \infty$, the curve and its tangent approach the line $x = 2a$.

(5) Let $\alpha: (-1, +\infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be given by

$$\alpha(t) = \left(\frac{3at}{1+t^3}, \frac{3at^2}{1+t^3} \right).$$

Prove that:

- For $t = 0$, α is tangent to the x axis.
- As $t \rightarrow +\infty$, $\alpha(t) \rightarrow (0, 0)$ and $\alpha'(t) \rightarrow (0, 0)$.
- Take the curve with the opposite orientation. Now, as $t \rightarrow -1$, the curve and its tangent approach the line $x + y + a = 0$.

The figure obtained by completing the trace of α in such a way that it becomes symmetric relative to the line $y = x$ is called the *folium of Descartes* (see Fig. 1-10).

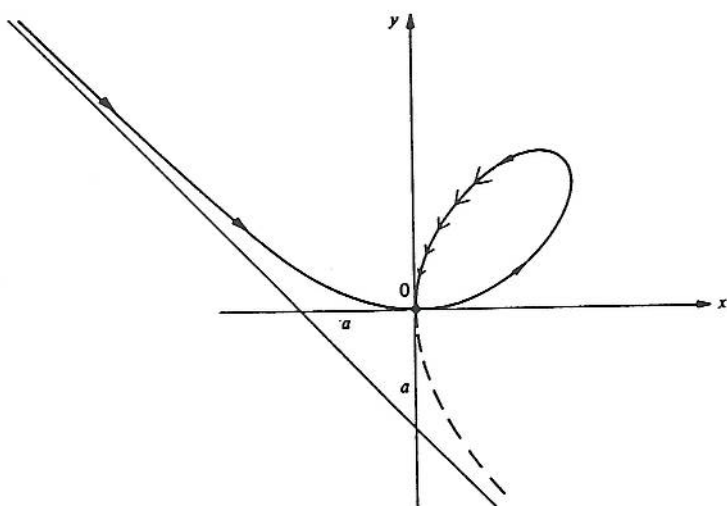


Figure 1-10. Folium of Descartes.

$$\begin{aligned} a) \quad \alpha'(t) &= \left(\frac{3a(1+t^3) - 3t^2(3at)}{(1+t^3)^2}, \frac{6at(1+t^3) - 3t^2(3at^2)}{(1+t^3)^2} \right) \\ &= \left(\frac{3a - 6at^3}{(1+t^3)^2}, \frac{6at - 3at^4}{(1+t^3)^2} \right) \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow 0} (3a, 0) \end{aligned}$$

Note $\alpha(0,0) = (0,0)$.

So the tangent line is $\begin{pmatrix} x-0 \\ y-0 \end{pmatrix} = t \begin{pmatrix} 3a \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow \begin{cases} x = 3at \\ y = 0 \end{cases}$

$\Rightarrow$ For $t=0$, α is tangent to the x axis.

b) It is clearly that $\alpha(t) \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} (0,0)$

By a), we see $\alpha'(t) \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} (0,0)$

$$\begin{aligned} c) \quad x(t) + y(t) + a &= \frac{3at}{1+t^3} + \frac{3at^2}{1+t^3} + a = \frac{3at + 3at^2 + a(1+t^3)}{1+t^3} \\ &= \frac{a(1+t)^3}{1+t^3} \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow -1} \frac{3a(1+t)^2}{3t^2} \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow -1} 0 \end{aligned}$$

Thus the curve tend to the line $x+y+a=0$

$$\text{and } \lim_{t \rightarrow -1} \frac{y(t)}{x(t)} = \lim_{t \rightarrow -1} \frac{\frac{3at^2}{1+t^2}}{\frac{3at}{1+t^2}} = \lim_{t \rightarrow -1} t = -1$$

thus the slope of the tangent line is -1

Since α approaches the line $x+y+a=0$ with slope also -1

thus α and its tangent both approach to $x+y+a=0$

⑥ Let $\alpha(t) = (ae^{bt} \cos t, ae^{bt} \sin t)$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$, a and b constants, $a > 0$, $b < 0$, be a parametrized curve.

- Show that as $t \rightarrow +\infty$, $\alpha(t)$ approaches the origin 0 , spiraling around it (because of this, the trace of α is called the *logarithmic spiral*; see Fig. 1-11).
- Show that $\alpha'(t) \rightarrow (0, 0)$ as $t \rightarrow +\infty$ and that

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow +\infty} \int_{t_0}^t |\alpha'(t)| dt$$

is finite; that is, α has finite arc length in $[t_0, \infty)$.

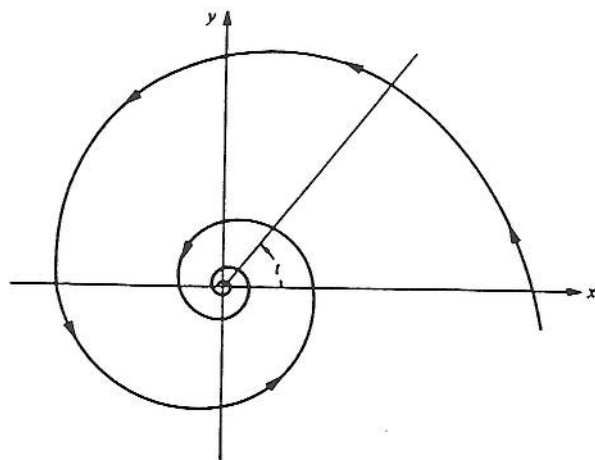


Figure 1-11. Logarithmic spiral.

$$\begin{aligned} a) \quad \alpha(t) &= (ae^{bt} \cos t, ae^{bt} \sin t) \\ &= \left(\frac{a \cos t}{e^{-bt}}, \frac{a \sin t}{e^{-bt}} \right) \xrightarrow{t \rightarrow \infty} (0, 0) \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{since } |a \sin t| \leq a, \quad |a \cos t| \leq a \quad (a > 0)$$

$$\text{and } \frac{1}{e^{-bt}} \xrightarrow[t < 0]{t \rightarrow +\infty} 0$$

$$\begin{aligned} b) \quad \alpha'(t) &= (abe^{bt} \cos t - ae^{bt} \sin t, abe^{bt} \sin t + ae^{bt} \cos t) \\ &= (e^{bt} (ab \cos t - a \sin t), e^{bt} (ab \sin t + a \cos t)) \end{aligned}$$

$$\xrightarrow{t \rightarrow +\infty} (0, 0) \quad \text{Since } |ab \cos t - a \sin t| \leq |ab| |\cos t| + |a| |\sin t| \leq a|b| + a, \quad a > 0$$

$$|ab \sin t + a \cos t| \leq a|b| + a, \quad a > 0$$

Let's calculate

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow +\infty} \int_{t_0}^t |\alpha'(t)| dt.$$

$$|\alpha'(t)|^2 = a^2 (e^{bt})^2 \left[(b \cos t - \sin t)^2 + (b \sin t + \cos t)^2 \right]$$

$$= a^2 (e^{bt})^2 \left(b^2 \cos^2 t - \cancel{2b \sin t \cos t} + \sin^2 t + b^2 \sin^2 t + \cancel{2b \sin t \cos t} + \cos^2 t \right)$$

$$= a^2 (e^{bt})^2 [b^2 + 1]$$

$$|\alpha'(t)| = a \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt}$$

$$\text{Now } \lim_{t \rightarrow +\infty} \int_{t_0}^t a \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt} dt = \lim_{t \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{a}{b} \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt} \Big|_{t_0}^t$$

($b < 0$)

$$= \lim_{t \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\frac{a}{b} \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt} - \frac{a}{b} \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt_0} \right)$$

$$= \frac{a}{(-b)} \sqrt{b^2 + 1} e^{bt_0}$$

thus α has finite length in $[t_0, +\infty)$.

From Lecture:

Exercise: The Viviani's curve is defined to be intersection of the sphere $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 4$ and the cylinder $(x-1)^2 + y^2 = 1$. Show that the length of the Viviani curve is greater than the length of the equator of the sphere.

Soln 1

$$\begin{cases} x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 4 & \dots (1) \\ (x-1)^2 + y^2 = 1 & \dots (2) \end{cases}$$

para. the cylinder $\Rightarrow \begin{cases} x-1 = \cos \theta \\ y = \sin \theta \\ z = z \end{cases} \quad (*)$

Please see
the picture
on next
page!

⊗ plugs into (1),

$$(1 + \cos \theta)^2 + \sin^2 \theta + z^2 = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow 1 + 2\cos \theta + \underbrace{\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta}_1 + z^2 = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow z^2 = 2 - 2\cos \theta = 2(1 - \cos \theta) = 2^2 \sin^2 \frac{\theta}{2}$$

$$\Rightarrow z = \pm 2 \sin \frac{\theta}{2}$$

Thus ⊗ $\Rightarrow \begin{cases} x = 1 + \cos \theta \\ y = \sin \theta \\ z = 2 \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \end{cases}$

So $\alpha(\theta) = (1 + \cos \theta, \sin \theta, 2 \sin \frac{\theta}{2})$ is the intersection

$$\alpha'(\theta) = (-\sin \theta, \cos \theta, \frac{1}{2} \cos \frac{\theta}{2})$$

$$|\alpha'(\theta)| = \sqrt{\sin^2 \theta + \cos^2 \theta + \cos^2 \frac{\theta}{2}} = \sqrt{1 + \cos^2 \frac{\theta}{2}}$$

see next page

$$L(\alpha) = \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{1 + \cos^2 \frac{\theta}{2}} d\theta \stackrel{\text{see next page}}{=} 15.2872 > 4\pi = 12.566$$

* See Solution 2 on next page!

Solun 2 $\begin{cases} x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 4 \dots (1) \\ (x-1)^2 + y^2 = 1 \dots (2) \end{cases}$

let $\begin{cases} x = 2\sin\theta \cos\varphi \\ y = 2\sin\theta \sin\varphi \\ z = 2\cos\theta \end{cases}$

be the parametrization of S^2 .

plug into (2): $(2\sin\theta \cos\varphi - 1)^2 + (2\sin\theta \sin\varphi)^2 = 1$

$$\Rightarrow 4\sin^2\theta \cos^2\varphi - 4\sin\theta \cos\varphi + 1 + 4\sin^2\theta \sin^2\varphi = 1$$

$$\Rightarrow \sin^2\theta - \sin\theta \cos\varphi = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sin\theta (\sin\theta - \cos\varphi) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sin\theta = \cos\varphi$$

w.l.g. assume $0 < \theta < \pi$

$$\begin{cases} x = 2\sin^2\theta \\ y = 2\sin\theta \sqrt{1-\cos^2\varphi} = 2\sin\theta \underbrace{\sqrt{1-\sin^2\theta}}_{\cos\theta} = 2\sin\theta \cos\theta = \sin 2\theta, \quad 0 \leq \theta \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \\ z = 2\cos\theta \end{cases}$$

$$\alpha(\theta) = (2\sin^2\theta, \sin 2\theta, 2\cos\theta)$$

$$\alpha'(\theta) = (\underbrace{4\sin\theta \cos\theta}_{2\sin 2\theta}, 2\cos 2\theta, -2\sin\theta)$$

$$|\alpha'(\theta)| = \sqrt{(2\sin 2\theta)^2 + (2\cos 2\theta)^2 + (-2\sin\theta)^2}$$

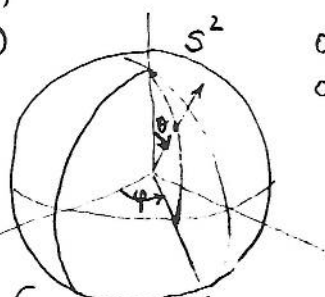
$$= \sqrt{4 + 4\sin^2\theta}$$

$$= \sqrt{4(1+\sin^2\theta)} = 2\sqrt{1+\sin^2\theta}$$

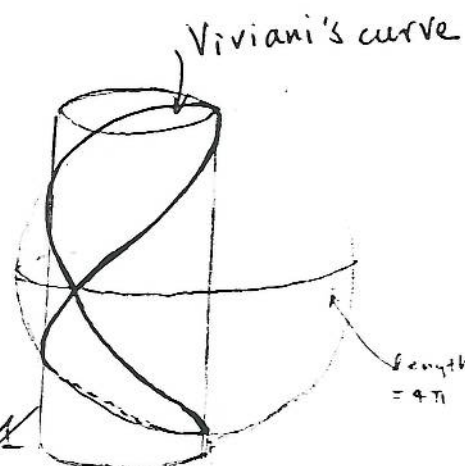
$\because 0 \leq \theta \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$

$$l(\alpha) = \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} 2\sqrt{1+\sin^2\theta} d\theta = 15.2872$$

$\int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} \sqrt{1+\sin^2\theta} d\theta = \text{elliptic E}(1) = 1.9109$



$$\begin{aligned} 0 \leq \theta \leq \pi \\ 0 \leq \varphi \leq 2\pi \end{aligned}$$



also $= 4\pi$

*8. Let $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ be a differentiable curve and let $[a, b] \subset I$ be a closed interval. For every partition

$$a = t_0 < t_1 < \dots < t_n = b$$

of $[a, b]$, consider the sum $\sum_{i=1}^n |\alpha(t_i) - \alpha(t_{i-1})| = l(\alpha, P)$, where P stands for the given partition. The norm $|P|$ of a partition P is defined as

$$|P| = \max(t_i - t_{i-1}), i = 1, \dots, n.$$

Geometrically, $l(\alpha, P)$ is the length of a polygon inscribed in $\alpha([a, b])$ with vertices in $\alpha(t_i)$ (see Fig. 1-12). The point of the exercise is to show that the arc length of $\alpha([a, b])$ is, in some sense, a limit of lengths of inscribed polygons.

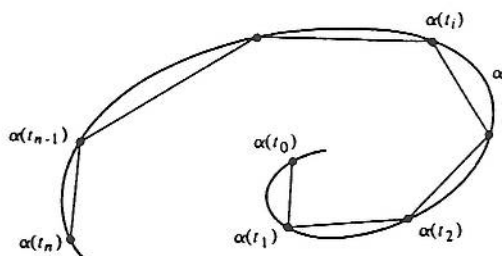


Figure 1-12

Prove that given $\epsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that if $|P| < \delta$ then

$$\left| \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt - l(\alpha, P) \right| < \epsilon.$$

Pf Recall by the definition of integral,

$$\int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt = \lim_{P \rightarrow 0} \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| \quad P = \max \{t_i - t_{i-1} \mid i = 1, 2, \dots, n\}$$

i.e. $\forall \epsilon > 0$, there $\exists \delta' > 0$ such that if $|P| < \delta'$, then

$$\left| \left(\int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt \right) - \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| \right| < \frac{\epsilon}{2}.$$

On the other hand, since α' is uniformly continuous in $[a, b]$, given $\epsilon > 0$, there $\exists \delta'' > 0$ such that whenever $t, s \in [a, b]$ with $|t - s| < \delta''$ then $|\alpha'(t) - \alpha'(s)| < \frac{\epsilon}{2(b-a)}$.

Set $\delta = \min(\delta', \delta'')$. Then if $|P| < \delta$, we obtain,

$$\left| \sum |\alpha(t_i) - \alpha(t_{i-1})| - \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| \right|$$

By mean value theorem

$$\alpha(t_i) - \alpha(t_{i-1}) = \alpha'(s_i)(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

$$= \alpha'(s_i)(t_i - t_{i-1}) \leq \sup |\alpha'(s_i)|$$

$$\leq \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) \sup |\alpha'(s_i) - \alpha'(t_i)| \leq (b-a) \frac{\epsilon}{2(b-a)} = \frac{\epsilon}{2}$$

$$\text{Now } \left| \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt - \ell(\alpha, p) \right|$$

$$= \left| \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt - \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| + \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| - \ell(\alpha, p) \right|$$

$$\leq \left| \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| dt - \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| \right| + \left| \sum (t_i - t_{i-1}) |\alpha'(t_i)| - \ell(\alpha, p) \right|$$

$$\leq \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon.$$

Q.E.D.

(10) (Straight Lines as Shortest.) Let $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ be a parametrized curve. Let $[a, b] \subset I$ and set $\alpha(a) = p$, $\alpha(b) = q$.

a. Show that, for any constant vector v , $|v| = 1$,

$$(q - p) \cdot v = \int_a^b \alpha'(t) \cdot v \, dt \leq \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| \, dt.$$

b. Set

$$v = \frac{q - p}{|q - p|}$$

and show that

$$|\alpha(b) - \alpha(a)| \leq \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| \, dt;$$

that is, the curve of shortest length from $\alpha(a)$ to $\alpha(b)$ is the straight line joining these points.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{a) } \int_a^b \alpha'(t) \cdot v \, dt & \stackrel{\text{Say } v = (v_1, v_2, v_3)}{\alpha(t) = (x(t), y(t), z(t))} \int_a^b (v_1 x_1'(t) + v_2 y_2'(t) + v_3 z_3'(t)) \, dt \\ &= v_1 x_1(t) + v_2 x_2(t) + v_3 x_3(t) \Big|_a^b = v \cdot \alpha(t) \Big|_a^b = v \cdot \alpha(b) - v \cdot \alpha(a) \\ &= v \cdot (q - p) \end{aligned}$$

On the other hand,

$$\int_a^b \alpha'(t) \cdot v \, dt \leq \int_a^b |\alpha'(t) \cdot v| \, dt \leq \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| |v| \, dt$$

$$\stackrel{|v|=1}{=} \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| \, dt$$

$$\text{thus we have: } (q - p) \cdot v = \int_a^b \alpha'(t) \cdot v \, dt \leq \int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| \, dt$$

$$\text{b) Now let } v = \frac{q - p}{|q - p|}, \text{ then } |v| = 1$$

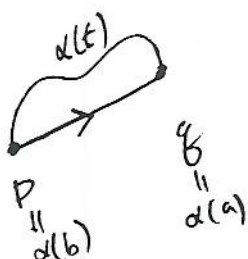
By a)

$$\int_a^b |\alpha'(t)| \, dt \geq (q - p) \cdot v$$

$$= (q - p) \cdot \frac{(q - p)}{|q - p|} = \frac{|q - p|^2}{|q - p|}$$

$$= |q - p| = |\alpha(b) - \alpha(a)|.$$

Thus, the curve of shortest length from $\alpha(a)$ to $\alpha(b)$ is the straight line joining these two pts.



sec. 1-5. The local theory of Curves Parametrized by Arc Length

EXERCISES

Unless explicitly stated, $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ is a curve parametrized by arc length s , with curvature $k(s) \neq 0$, for all $s \in I$.

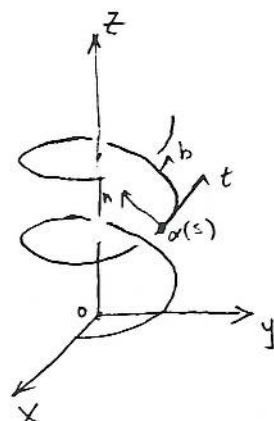
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1. Given the parametrized curve (helix)

$$\alpha(s) = \left(a \cos \frac{s}{c}, a \sin \frac{s}{c}, b \frac{s}{c} \right), \quad s \in \mathbb{R},$$

where $c^2 = a^2 + b^2$, $a > 0$, $b > 0$

- Show that the parameter s is the arc length.
- Determine the curvature and the torsion of α .
- Determine the osculating plane of α .
- Show that the lines containing $n(s)$ and passing through $\alpha(s)$ meet the z axis under a constant angle equal to $\pi/2$.
- Show that the tangent lines to α make a constant angle with the z axis.



$$a) \alpha'(s) = \left(-\frac{a}{c} \sin \frac{s}{c}, \frac{a}{c} \cos \frac{s}{c}, \frac{b}{c} \right)$$

$$|\alpha'(s)|^2 = \left(\frac{a}{c} \right)^2 \left(\sin^2 \frac{s}{c} + \cos^2 \frac{s}{c} \right) + \left(\frac{b}{c} \right)^2 = \frac{a^2 + b^2}{c^2} = 1$$

$\Rightarrow s$ is the arc length

$$b) \alpha''(s) = \left(-\frac{a}{c^2} \cos \frac{s}{c}, -\frac{a}{c^2} \sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right)$$

$$|\alpha''(s)| = \sqrt{\left(\frac{a}{c^2} \right)^2} = \frac{a}{c^2} = \frac{a}{a^2 + b^2}$$

$$\Rightarrow K(s) = \frac{a}{a^2 + b^2} = \frac{a}{c^2}, \quad \forall s \in I$$

$$c) n(s) = \frac{\alpha''(s)}{|\alpha''(s)|} = \frac{c^2}{a} \left(-\frac{a}{c^2} \cos \frac{s}{c}, -\frac{a}{c^2} \sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right) = \left(-\cos \frac{s}{c}, -\sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right)$$

$$t(s) = \alpha'(s) = \left(-\frac{a}{c} \sin \frac{s}{c}, \frac{a}{c} \cos \frac{s}{c}, \frac{b}{c} \right)$$

$$\text{the osculating plane} = \text{span}(t(s), n(s)) = \left\{ x t(s) + y n(s) \mid x, y \in \mathbb{R} \right\}$$

$$d) z\text{-axis} = \text{span}\{V\}, \quad V = (0, 0, 1)$$

$$\cos \langle V, n(s) \rangle = \frac{V \cdot n}{|V| |n|} = (0, 0, 1) \cdot (-\cos \frac{s}{c}, -\sin \frac{s}{c}, 0) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \langle V, n(s) \rangle = \frac{\pi}{2} \quad \left(\begin{array}{l} \text{Note:} \\ 0 \leq \langle V, n(s) \rangle \leq \pi \end{array} \right)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{n}(s) &= \frac{\alpha''(s)}{|\alpha''(s)|} = \left(-\cos \frac{s}{c}, -\sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right) \\ \vec{b}(s) &= \vec{t}(s) \times \vec{n}(s) = \begin{vmatrix} \vec{i} & \vec{j} & \vec{k} \\ -\frac{a}{c} \sin \frac{s}{c} & \frac{a}{c} \cos \frac{s}{c} & \frac{b}{c} \\ -\cos \frac{s}{c} & -\sin \frac{s}{c} & 0 \end{vmatrix} \\ &= \left[\frac{b}{c} \sin \frac{s}{c} \right] \vec{i} - \left[\frac{b}{c} \cos \frac{s}{c} \right] \vec{j} + \frac{a}{c} \vec{k} \\ \vec{b}'(s) &= \left[\frac{b}{c^2} \cos \frac{s}{c}, \frac{b}{c^2} \sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right] \\ &= -\frac{b}{c^2} \left[-\cos \frac{s}{c}, -\sin \frac{s}{c}, 0 \right] \\ &= -\frac{b}{c^2} \vec{n}(s) \end{aligned}$$

therefore $\tau(s) = -\frac{b}{c^2}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 e) \cos \langle v, t(s) \rangle &= \frac{v \cdot t(s)}{|v| |t(s)|} = (0, 0, 1) \cdot \left(-\frac{a}{c} \sin \frac{s}{c}, \frac{a}{c} \cos \frac{s}{c}, \frac{b}{c} \right) \\
 &= \frac{b}{c} \quad (\text{where } 0 \leq \langle v, t(s) \rangle \leq \pi)
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow \langle v, t(s) \rangle = \arccos \frac{b}{c}$$

Note: $\arccos \frac{b}{c}$ is a constant since $\cos x$ is monotone decreasing over $[0, \pi]$ and by inverse function thm $\arccos x$ is well defined.

Thus $\langle v, t(s) \rangle$ is a constant angle, for $\forall s \in I$.

*2. Show that the torsion τ of α is given by

$$\tau(s) = -\frac{\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s) \cdot \alpha'''(s)}{|k(s)|^2}$$

Pf: We are going to show $\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s) \cdot \alpha'''(s) = -\tau(s) K^2$

Recall $\alpha'(s) = t(s)$

$$\alpha''(s) = K(s) n(s)$$

$$\alpha'''(s) = K'(s) n(s) + K(s) n'(s)$$

$$= K'(s) n(s) + K(s) (-K(s) t(s) - \tau(s) b(s))$$

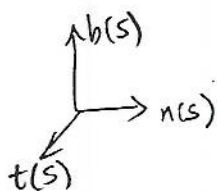
$$= K'(s) n(s) - K^2(s) t(s) - K(s) \tau(s) b(s)$$

Now $\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s) = K(s) (t(s) \wedge n(s))$

$$(\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s)) \cdot \alpha'''(s) = K(s) (t(s) \wedge n(s)) \cdot (K'(s) n(s) - K^2(s) t(s) - K(s) \tau(s) b(s))$$

$$= K(s) K'(s) \underbrace{(t(s) \wedge n(s)) \cdot n(s)}_{\rightarrow 0} - K^3(s) \underbrace{(t(s) \wedge n(s)) \cdot t(s)}_{\rightarrow 0} - K^2(s) \tau(s) \underbrace{(t(s) \wedge n(s)) \cdot b(s)}_{\rightarrow 1}$$

$$= -K^2(s) \tau(s) b(s) \cdot b(s) = -K^2(s) \tau(s) |b(s)|^2 = -K^2(s) \tau(s)$$



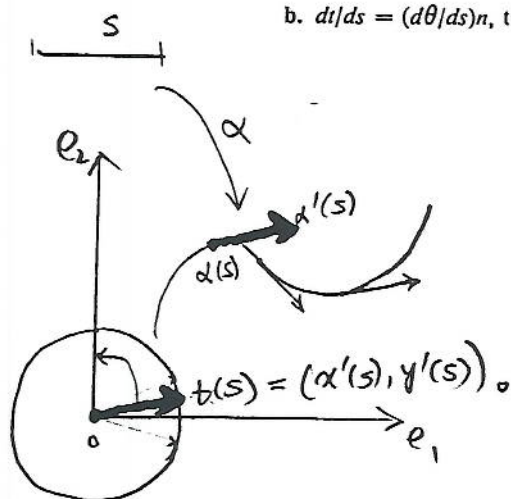
Thus $\tau(s) = -\frac{(\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s)) \cdot \alpha'''(s)}{K^2(s)}$

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3. Assume that $\alpha(I) \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ (i.e., α is a plane curve) and give k a sign as in the text. Transport the vectors $t(s)$ parallel to themselves in such a way that the origins of $t(s)$ agree with the origin of $\mathbb{R}^2$; the end points of $t(s)$ then describe a parametrized curve $s \rightarrow t(s)$ called the *indicatrix of tangents* of α . Let $\theta(s)$ be the angle from e_1 to $t(s)$ in the orientation of $\mathbb{R}^2$. Prove (a) and (b) (notice that we are assuming that $k \neq 0$).

a. The indicatrix of tangents is a regular parametrized curve.

b. $dt/ds = (d\theta/ds)n$, that is, $k = d\theta/ds$.



a) proof: Let $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be a curve parametrized by arc length.

Then $\alpha'(s) = (x'(s), y'(s))_{\alpha(s)} = \underset{\text{at } \alpha(s)}{t(s)}$ has norm of 1.

Let's transport $t(s)$ parallel to themselves in such a way that the start point of $t(s)$ agree with the origin of $\mathbb{R}^2$. We obtain a vector $t(s)$ at 0.

Now since $|t(s)| = 1 \Rightarrow$ all $t(s)$ lies on a circle.

Now $t'(s) = (x''(s), y''(s))_0 \Rightarrow |t'(s)| = \sqrt{(x''(s))^2 + (y''(s))^2} = k(s)$

Since we assume $k(s) \neq 0 \Rightarrow |t'(s)| \neq 0$

$\Rightarrow t(s)$ is regular

b) Now write $t(s) = (\cos \theta(s), \sin \theta(s))$

$$\Rightarrow t'(s) = (-\sin \theta(s) \theta'(s), \cos \theta(s) \theta'(s))$$

$$= (-\sin \theta(s), \cos \theta(s)) \theta'(s)$$

$$= \frac{d\theta}{ds} n(s)$$

$$\Rightarrow k(s) = \frac{d\theta}{ds}$$

Q.E.D.

(5) A regular parametrized curve α has the property that all its tangent lines pass through a fixed point.

- Prove that the trace of α is a (segment of a) straight line.
- Does the conclusion in part a still hold if α is not regular?

a) Let P be the fixed pt. Let α be parametrized by arclength $s \in I$.
 A tangent line at $\alpha(s)$ ^{is a line with} direction $\alpha'(s)$ and passing a point $\alpha(s)$:
 $\ell(t) = \alpha'(s)t + \alpha(s)$.

By hypothesis, for each choice of s , there exists $t(s)$ (t depends on the choice of s) such that $\alpha'(s)t(s) + \alpha(s) = P \dots (*)$

Then $t(s)$ that satisfies this equation must be a differentiable function of s since $|\alpha'(s)| \neq 0$. (In fact,
 $\alpha'(s)t(s) = P - \alpha(s) \Rightarrow \alpha'(s) \cdot \alpha'(s)t(s) = (P - \alpha(s)) \cdot \alpha'(s)$
 $\Rightarrow t(s) = \frac{(P - \alpha(s)) \cdot \alpha'(s)}{|\alpha'(s)|^2}$.)

Let's differentiate $(*)$ both sides with respect to s ,

$$\Rightarrow \alpha''(s)t(s) + \alpha'(s)t'(s) + \alpha'(s) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow t(s)\alpha''(s) + (t'(s) + 1)\alpha'(s) = 0 \dots (**)$$

Now since α is parametrized by arclength $\Rightarrow \alpha'(s) \perp \alpha''(s)$

$\Rightarrow$ either $\alpha'(s)$ and $\alpha''(s)$ linearly-independent or $\alpha''(s) = 0$
 (since $\alpha'(s) \neq 0$)

But if $\alpha'(s), \alpha''(s)$ linearly indep $\Rightarrow t(s) = 0$ and $t'(s) + 1 = 0$

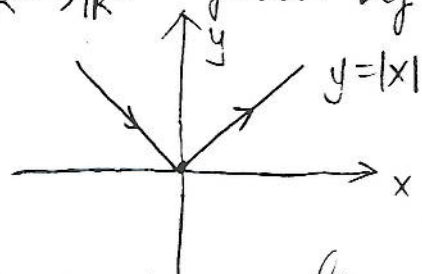
That is a contradiction. Thus we must have $\alpha''(s) = 0$

$\Rightarrow \alpha'(s) = \vec{c} \Rightarrow \alpha(s) = s\vec{c} + \vec{d}$, where $\vec{c}, \vec{d}$ are constant vectors.
 $\Rightarrow \alpha(s)$ is a (segment of a) straight line.

b) the conclusion does not hold if α is not regular.

How to make an example?

First note: a) fails for a non parametrized curve
 $\alpha: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ given by $\alpha(t) = (t, |t|)$



all the tangent line of α pass through 0 (except at 0, the tangent line is not well defined).

We are going to modify α to make it to be a parametrized curve.

Let's consider

$$\beta(t) = \begin{cases} (0, 0), & t=0 \\ (e^{\frac{1}{t}}, -e^{\frac{1}{t}}), & t < 0 \\ (e^{-\frac{1}{t}}, e^{-\frac{1}{t}}), & t > 0 \end{cases}$$

$\beta(t)$ on x, y plane is a curve $y = |x|$. But now

$$x(t) = \begin{cases} e^{\frac{1}{t}}, & t < 0 \\ 0, & t = 0 \\ e^{-\frac{1}{t}}, & t > 0 \end{cases}, \quad y(t) = \begin{cases} -e^{-\frac{1}{t}}, & t < 0 \\ 0, & t = 0 \\ e^{-\frac{1}{t}}, & t > 0 \end{cases}$$

both smooth (i.e. infinitely differentiable)

It suffices to check $x(t), y(t)$ are differentiable at 0:

For $x(t)$: $\lim_{t \rightarrow -0} (e^{\frac{1}{t}})' = \lim_{t \rightarrow -0} -\frac{1}{t^2} e^{\frac{1}{t}} = 0$, $\lim_{t \rightarrow +0} (e^{-\frac{1}{t}})' = \lim_{t \rightarrow +0} \frac{1}{t^2} e^{-\frac{1}{t}} = 0$

Similar for $y(t)$. (In fact all of its derivatives are 0 at $t=0$ since exponential function tends to 0 much fast than a polynomial function tends zero.) $\Rightarrow \beta(t)$ is a differentiable parametrized curve which is not a line segment but with all tangent lines pass through the origin.

6. A translation by a vector v in R^3 is the map $A: R^3 \rightarrow R^3$ that is given by $A(p) = p + v$, $p \in R^3$. A linear map $p: R^3 \rightarrow R^3$ is an orthogonal transformation when $pu \cdot pv = u \cdot v$ for all vectors $u, v \in R^3$. A rigid motion in R^3 is the result of composing a translation with an orthogonal transformation with positive determinant (this last condition is included because we expect rigid motions to preserve orientation).

- Demonstrate that the norm of a vector and the angle θ between two vectors, $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi$, are invariant under orthogonal transformations with positive determinant.
- Show that the vector product of two vectors is invariant under orthogonal transformations with positive determinant. Is the assertion still true if we drop the condition on the determinant?
- Show that the arc length, the curvature, and the torsion of a parametrized curve are (whenever defined) invariant under rigid motions.

a) Let $u = v$ in $pu \cdot pv = u \cdot v \Rightarrow |pv|^2 = |v|^2 \Rightarrow |pv| = |v|$
 $\cos \langle pu, pv \rangle = \frac{pu \cdot pv}{|pu| |pv|} = \frac{u \cdot v}{|u| |v|} = \cos \langle u, v \rangle \Rightarrow \text{angle} \langle pu, pv \rangle = \text{angle} \langle u, v \rangle$
 if $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi$.

b) By a proposition from our lecture, we have:

Let $v, w \in E^3$. Let p be an orthogonal transformation of E^3

Then $p(v \times w) = (\det p)(pv \times pw)$.

$\because \det p = 1 \Rightarrow p(v \times w) = pv \times pw$ (i.e. what we want to show)
 (As you may recall the proof of above proposition used algebraic method.)

Let's prove b) again in a geometric method.

Since p is an orthonormal transformation, it preserves angles. Now since $v \times w$ perpendicular to v and $w \Rightarrow p(v \times w)$ perpendicular to $p(v)$ and $p(w)$. Hence $p(v \times w)$ perpendicular to the plane spanned by $p(v), p(w)$. Now $p(v) \times p(w)$ also perpendicular to the plane spanned by $p(v)$ and $p(w)$.

Moreover $|p(v) \times p(w)| = |p(v)| |p(w)| \sin \langle p(v), p(w) \rangle$
 $= |v| |w| \sin \langle v, w \rangle = |v \times w| = |p(v \times w)|$

thus $p(v) \times p(w) = \pm p(v \times w)$... (*)

Now since $\det p = 1 \Rightarrow p$ keeps orientation of a basis of E^3

Since $\{v, w, v \times w\}$ is a basis w/ positive orientation $\Rightarrow \det(v, w, v \times w) = 1$
 Now $\det(pv, pw, p(v \times w)) = \det p \cdot \det(v, w, v \times w) = 1 \cdot 1 = 1$
 Also $\det(pv, pw, pv \times pw) = \det p \cdot \det(v, w, v \times w) = 1 \cdot 1 = 1$
 So $\{p(v), p(w), p(v \times w)\}$ is a basis of positive orientation.

Now $\{pv, pw, (pv \times pw)\}$ is a basis of positive orientation.

(*) implies $p(v \times w) = pv \times pw$.

Let A be a translation by V in $\mathbb{R}^3$

c) Then $A(\alpha(t)) = \alpha(t) + V \Rightarrow [A(\alpha(t))]'_t = (\alpha(t) + V)'_t = \alpha'(t)$

Let P be an O.N transformation with positive determinant

$$P(\alpha(t)) = \begin{bmatrix} p_{11} & p_{12} & p_{13} \\ p_{21} & p_{22} & p_{23} \\ p_{31} & p_{32} & p_{33} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x(t) \\ y(t) \\ z(t) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} p_{11}x(t) + p_{12}y(t) + p_{13}z(t) \\ p_{21}x(t) + p_{22}y(t) + p_{23}z(t) \\ p_{31}x(t) + p_{32}y(t) + p_{33}z(t) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} [P(\alpha(t))]'_t &= \begin{bmatrix} p_{11}x'(t) + p_{12}y'(t) + p_{13}z'(t) \\ p_{21}x'(t) + p_{22}y'(t) + p_{23}z'(t) \\ p_{31}x'(t) + p_{32}y'(t) + p_{33}z'(t) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} p_{11} & p_{12} & p_{13} \\ p_{21} & p_{22} & p_{23} \\ p_{31} & p_{32} & p_{33} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x'(t) \\ y'(t) \\ z'(t) \end{bmatrix} \\ &= P\alpha'(t) \end{aligned}$$

Further, we have $[A(\alpha(t))]''_t = A\alpha''(t)$, $[A(\alpha(t))]'_t = A\alpha'''(t)$

$$[P\alpha(t)]''_t = P\alpha''(t), \quad [P\alpha(t)]'''_t = P\alpha'''(t)$$

Therefore arclength is preserved under the rigid motion R . Since

$$\int_{t_0}^t |(R\alpha(s))'| ds = \int_{t_0}^t |R\alpha'(s)| ds = \int_{t_0}^t |\alpha'(s)| ds$$

Note: A rigid motion also preserves the regularity of a curve.

$$|(A\alpha(s))'| = |A\alpha'(s)| = |\alpha'(s)| \neq 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (A\alpha(s))' \neq 0$$

Now the curvature of α is preserved since

$$|(A\alpha(s))''| = |A\alpha''(s)| = |\alpha''(s)| \quad (\text{i.e. } K_{A\alpha(s)} = K_{\alpha(s)})$$

and torsion is preserved since

$$\begin{aligned} \tau_{A\alpha(s)} &= - \frac{[(A\alpha(s))' \times (A\alpha(s))''] \cdot (A\alpha(s))'''}{K_{A\alpha(s)}} = - \frac{[A\alpha'(s) \times A\alpha''(s)] \cdot A\alpha'''(s)}{K_{A\alpha(s)}} \\ &= - \frac{A(\alpha'(s) \times \alpha''(s)) \cdot A\alpha'''(s)}{K_{A\alpha(s)}} = - \frac{[\alpha'(s) \times \alpha''(s)] \cdot \alpha'''(s)}{K_{\alpha(s)}} = \tau_{\alpha(s)} \end{aligned}$$

(*) Let $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be a regular parametrized plane curve (arbitrary parameter), and define $n = n(t)$ and $k = k(t)$ as in Remark 1. Assume that $k(t) \neq 0$, $t \in I$. In this situation, the curve

$$\beta(t) = \alpha(t) + \frac{1}{k(t)} n(t), \quad t \in I,$$

is called the *evolute* of α (Fig. 1-17).

- Show that the tangent at t of the evolute of α is the normal to α at t .
- Consider the normal lines of α at two neighboring points t_1, t_2 , $t_1 \neq t_2$. Let t_1 approach t_2 and show that the intersection points of the normals converge to a point on the trace of the evolute of α .

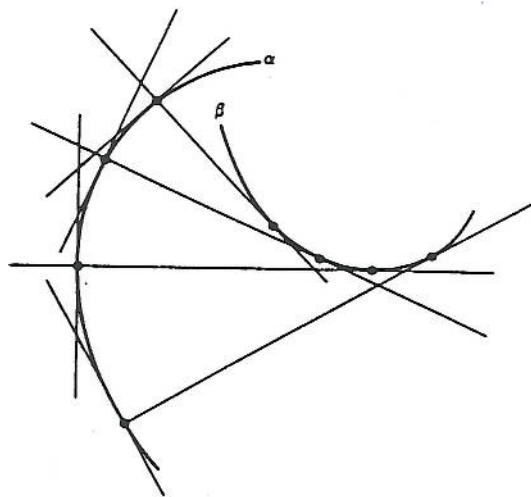


Figure 1-17

- a) Without loss of generality, we can assume α is parametrized by arc length. [Since we always can reparametrize α by arclength: $\bar{\alpha}(s) = \alpha(t(s))$. Then we can write the evolute of $\alpha(t(s))$
- $$\beta(t(s)) = \alpha(t(s)) + \frac{1}{k(t(s))} n(t(s))$$

as $\bar{\beta}(s) = \bar{\alpha}(s) + \frac{1}{k(s)} \bar{n}(s).$]

Now let's differentiate the evolute of $\alpha(s)$:

$$\beta(s) = \alpha(s) + \frac{1}{k(s)} n(s) \quad s \in I$$

both sides with respect to s .

$$\Rightarrow \beta'(s) = \alpha'(s) + \frac{-k'(s)}{k^2(s)} n(s) + \frac{1}{k(s)} n'(s) \quad \dots (*)$$

We wish to show $\alpha'(s) \perp \beta'(s)$.

Let's dot (*) both sides by $\alpha'(s)$

$$\Rightarrow \beta'(s) \cdot \alpha'(s) = \alpha'(s) \cdot \alpha'(s) + \frac{-k'(s)}{k^2(s)} n(s) \cdot \alpha'(s) + \frac{1}{k(s)} (k'(s)t(s) - k(s)b(s)) \cdot \alpha'(s)$$

$\because n(s) \perp t(s)$
 $t(s) = \alpha'(s)$
 $\alpha'(s) \cdot \alpha'(s) = |t(s)|^2 = 1$
 $\alpha'(s) \cdot n(s) = 0$
 $\alpha'(s) \cdot b(s) = 0$

$$= |t(s)|^2 - |t(s)|^2 = 0$$

b) Parametrize α by arc length. The normalizes at s_1 and are

$$L_1(\lambda) = \alpha(s_1) + \lambda n(s_1), \quad L_2(\sigma) = \alpha(s_2) + \sigma n(s_2), \quad \lambda, \sigma \in \mathbb{R}$$

To solve the intersection, viz let $L_1(\lambda) = L_2(\sigma)$. This gives us

$$\alpha(s_1) + \lambda n(s_1) = \alpha(s_2) + \sigma n(s_2)$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1) = \lambda n(s_1) - \sigma n(s_2)$$

divide by $s_2 - s_1$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} = \frac{\lambda n(s_1) - \sigma n(s_2)}{s_2 - s_1}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} = \frac{\lambda n(s_1) - \sigma n(s_2) + \sigma n(s_1) - \sigma n(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} = -\frac{\sigma(n(s_2) - n(s_1))}{s_2 - s_1} + \frac{(\lambda - \sigma)n(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1}$$

Let's dot both sides by $\alpha'(s_1)$.

$$\Rightarrow \left(\frac{\alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} \right) \cdot \alpha'(s_1) = -\sigma \frac{n(s_2) - n(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} \cdot \alpha'(s_1) + \frac{(\lambda - \sigma)n(s_1) \cdot \alpha'(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1}$$

Now let's take the limit both sides for $s_2 \rightarrow s_1$.

$$\Rightarrow \lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \frac{\alpha(s_2) - \alpha(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} \cdot \alpha'(s_1) = -\left(\lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \sigma \right) \lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \frac{n(s_2) - n(s_1)}{s_2 - s_1} \cdot \alpha'(s_1)$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha'(s_1) \cdot \alpha'(s_1) = \left(\lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \sigma \right) n'(s_1) \cdot \alpha'(s_1)$$

$$\Rightarrow |\alpha'(s_1)|^2 = \left(\lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \sigma \right) (-K(s_1) t(s_1) - t(s_1) b(s_1)) \alpha'(s_1)$$

$$\Rightarrow |\alpha'(s_1)|^2 = \left(\lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \sigma \right) K(s_1) \cdot |\alpha'(s_1)|^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} |\alpha'(s_1)| &= 1 \\ \Rightarrow \lim_{s_2 \rightarrow s_1} \sigma &= \frac{1}{K} \end{aligned}$$

Thus the intersection pt is $L_2(\sigma) = \alpha(s_2) + \frac{1}{K} n(s_2)$ which is

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8. The trace of the parametrized curve (arbitrary parameter)

$$\alpha(t) = (t, \cosh t), \quad t \in \mathbb{R},$$

is called the *catenary*.

a. Show that the signed curvature (cf. Remark 1) of the catenary is

$$k(t) = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t}.$$

b. Show that the evolute (cf. Exercise 7) of the catenary is

$$\beta(t) = (t - \sinh t \cosh t, 2 \cosh t).$$

a) To show $K(t) = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t}$, we can use prob. 12 (Last HW assign.)

$$K(t) = \frac{|\alpha'(t) \times \alpha''(t)|}{|\alpha'(t)|^3}$$

$$\text{Now } \alpha'(t) = (1, \sinh t) \Rightarrow |\alpha'(t)|^2 = \sqrt{1 + \sinh^2 t} = \cosh t$$

$$\alpha''(t) = (0, \cosh t)$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha' \times \alpha'' = \begin{vmatrix} \vec{i} & \vec{j} & \vec{k} \\ 1 & \sinh t & 0 \\ 0 & \cosh t & 0 \end{vmatrix} = (\cosh t) \vec{k} \Rightarrow |\alpha' \times \alpha''| = \cosh t$$

$$\text{Thus } K(t) = \frac{\cosh t}{\cosh^3 t} = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t}$$

Another way to show a) is by directly reparametrizing $\alpha(t)$ by arc length.

$$\text{Let } s(t) = \int_0^t |\alpha'(t)| dt = \int_0^t \sqrt{1 + (\sinh t)^2} dt = \int_0^t \cosh t dt = \sinh t$$

$$\Rightarrow s(t) = \sinh t \Rightarrow t = \sinh^{-1}(s) \therefore \text{Let's denote this inverse function}$$

$$\text{by } t = g(s). \left(\begin{array}{l} g(s(t)) = t \\ g'(s(t)) = \frac{1}{s'(t)} \end{array} \right) \text{ Let } \beta = \alpha \circ g. \text{ Then } |\beta'(s)| = 1$$

$$\beta(s) = (g(s), \cosh(g(s)))$$

$$\beta'(s) = (g'(s), \sinh(g(s)) g'(s)) = (g'(s), s g'(s)).$$

$$\beta''(s) = (g''(s), g'(s) + s g''(s)). \text{ There, for } \alpha$$

$$K(t) n(t) = (g''(s(t)), g'(s(t)) + s(t) g''(s(t)))$$

(We want to compute $K(t)$ for $\alpha(t)$. So we want to consider β'' at the pt $\alpha(t)$. But this is $\beta(s(t))$ since $\beta(s(t)) = \alpha(g(s(t))) = \alpha(t)$ (Recall $g = s^{-1}$).

Notice that $g(s(t)) = t \Rightarrow g'(s(t)) = \frac{1}{s'(t)} = \frac{1}{\cosh t}$
 and $g''(s(t_0)) = \frac{-s''(t)}{(s'(t))^3} = \frac{-s(t)}{\cosh^3(t)}$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow \beta''(s(t)) &= \left(\frac{-s(t)}{\cosh^3 t}, \frac{1}{\cosh t} - \frac{(s(t))^2}{\cosh^3(t)} \right) \\ &= \left(\frac{-\sinh t}{\cosh^3(t)}, \frac{\cosh^2 t - \sinh^2 t}{\cosh^3(t)} \right) \\ &= \left(\frac{-\sinh t}{\cosh^3(t)}, \frac{1}{\cosh^3(t)} \right) \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow |\beta''(s(t))| = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow \pm n(t) &= \frac{\beta''(s(t))}{|\beta''(s(t))|} = \left(\frac{-\sinh t}{\cosh^3 t} \cdot \cosh^2 t, \frac{1}{\cosh^3(t)} \cosh^2 t \right) \\ &= \left(-\frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t}, \frac{1}{\cosh t} \right) \triangleq V \end{aligned}$$

But $\det(\beta'(s(t)) \quad V) = \begin{vmatrix} \frac{1}{\cosh t} & -\frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t} \\ \frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t} & \frac{1}{\cosh t} \end{vmatrix} = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t} + \frac{\sinh^2 t}{\cosh^2 t} = 1$

$$\begin{aligned} \beta'(s(t)) &= (g'(s(t)), s(t)g'(s(t))) \\ &= \left(\frac{1}{s'(t)}, \frac{s(t)}{s'(t)} \right) \\ &= \left(\frac{1}{\cosh t}, \frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Thus $n(t) = \left(-\frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t}, \frac{1}{\cosh t} \right)$

Now $\beta''(s(t)) = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t} n(t)$

$\Rightarrow K(t) = \frac{1}{\cosh^2 t}$ is the signed curvature.

b) The evolute of the catenary is

$$\begin{aligned} \beta(t) &= \alpha(t) + \frac{1}{K(t)} n(t) = (t, \cosh t) + \cosh^2 t \left(-\frac{\sinh t}{\cosh t}, \frac{1}{\cosh t} \right) \\ &= (t - \sinh t \cosh t, 2 \cosh t). \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} g(s(t)) &= t \\ \Rightarrow \frac{dg}{ds} \cdot \frac{ds}{dt} &= 1 \Rightarrow \frac{ds}{ds} = \frac{1}{\frac{ds}{dt}} \\ \Rightarrow \frac{d^2 g}{ds^2} \cdot \frac{ds}{dt} \cdot \frac{ds}{dt} + \frac{dg}{ds} \cdot \frac{d^2 s}{dt^2} &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow \frac{d^2 g}{ds^2} &= -\frac{\frac{d^2 s}{dt^2}}{\left(\frac{ds}{dt}\right)^2} = -\frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{1}{\frac{ds}{dt}} \right) \end{aligned}$$

12. Let $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ be a regular parametrized curve (not necessarily by arc length) and let $\beta: J \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ be a reparametrization of $\alpha(I)$ by the arc length $s = s(t)$, measured from $t_0 \in I$ (see Remark 2). Let $t = t(s)$ be the inverse function of s and set $d\alpha/dt = \alpha'$, $d^2\alpha/dt^2 = \alpha''$, etc. Prove that

a. $dt/ds = 1/|\alpha'|$, $d^2t/ds^2 = -(\alpha' \cdot \alpha'')/|\alpha'|^4$.

b. The curvature of α at $t \in I$ is

$$k(t) = \frac{|\alpha' \wedge \alpha''|}{|\alpha'|^3}.$$

c. The torsion of α at $t \in I$ is

$$\tau(t) = -\frac{(\alpha' \wedge \alpha'') \cdot \alpha'''}{|\alpha' \wedge \alpha''|^2}.$$

d. If $\alpha: I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ is a plane curve $\alpha(t) = (x(t), y(t))$, the signed curvature (see Remark 1) of α at t is

$$k(t) = \frac{x'y'' - x''y'}{((x')^2 + (y')^2)^{3/2}}.$$

a) Recall $s(t) = \int_{t_0}^t |\alpha'(t)| dt$

$$\frac{ds}{dt} = |\alpha'(t)| \Rightarrow \frac{dt}{ds} = \frac{1}{|\alpha'(t)|} = \frac{1}{\alpha'} \quad \alpha' \triangleq \alpha'(t)$$

$$\frac{d^2t}{ds^2} = \frac{d}{ds} \left(\frac{1}{|\alpha'(t(s))|} \right) = - \frac{\frac{d}{ds} |\alpha'(t(s))|}{|\alpha'(t(s))|^2}$$

$$\frac{d}{ds} \left(\sqrt{(x'(t(s)))^2 + (y'(t(s)))^2 + (z'(t(s)))^2} \right) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x'^2 + y'^2 + z'^2}} \left(x'(t(s))x''(t(s))\frac{dt}{ds} + 2 \left(\dots \right) + z'(t(s))z''(t(s))\frac{dt}{ds} \right)$$

$$= \frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha'' \frac{dt}{ds}}{|\alpha'|} = \frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha''}{|\alpha'|^2}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{d^2t}{ds^2} = - \frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha''}{|\alpha'|^4}$$

b) $k_\alpha(t) = k_\beta(s) = |\beta''(s)|$

$$\beta = \alpha(t(s)) \Rightarrow \frac{d\beta}{ds} = \frac{d\alpha}{dt} \frac{dt}{ds}$$

$$\frac{d^2\beta}{ds^2} = \frac{d^2\alpha}{dt^2} \left(\frac{dt}{ds} \right)^2 + \frac{d\alpha}{dt} \frac{d^2t}{ds^2}$$

$$= \alpha''(t) \frac{1}{|\alpha'(t)|^2} - \frac{\alpha'(t) (\alpha' \cdot \alpha'')}{|\alpha'(t)|^4}$$

i.e. $\beta''(s) = \frac{(\alpha' \cdot \alpha'')\alpha'' - (\alpha' \cdot \alpha'')\alpha'}{|\alpha'(t)|^4} = \frac{(\alpha' \times \alpha'') \times \alpha'}{|\alpha'|^4}$

$$|\beta''(s)| = \frac{|\alpha' \times \alpha''| |\alpha'| \sin \langle \alpha' \times \alpha'', \alpha' \rangle}{|\alpha'|^4} = \frac{|\alpha' \times \alpha''|}{|\alpha'|^3}, \text{ Since}$$

$$\sin \langle \alpha' \times \alpha'', \alpha' \rangle = \sin \frac{\pi}{2} = 1$$

c) Let $\beta(s) = \alpha(t(s))$ be a reparametrization of $\alpha(t)$ by arclength. We may use Ex 2, p. 22 to compute the torsion. We apply the formula to $\beta(s)$. We wish to compute

$$-\frac{(\beta'(s) \wedge \beta''(s)) \cdot \beta'''(s)}{|\beta'(s)|^2}$$

$$\beta' = \frac{\alpha'}{|\alpha'|} \quad \text{and} \quad \beta'' = \frac{\alpha''(\alpha' \cdot \alpha') - \alpha'(\alpha' \cdot \alpha'')}{|\alpha'|^4}, \quad \text{so}$$

$$\beta' \wedge \beta'' = \frac{\alpha'}{|\alpha'|} \wedge \frac{\alpha''(\alpha' \cdot \alpha')}{|\alpha'|^4} = \frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha' (\alpha' \wedge \alpha'')}{|\alpha'|^5} = \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3} (\alpha' \wedge \alpha'')$$

We next compute $\beta'''(s)$

$$\begin{aligned} \beta'''(s) &= \frac{d^3 \alpha}{dt^3} \frac{dt}{ds} \left(\frac{dt}{ds} \right)^2 + \frac{d^2 \alpha}{dt^2} 2 \left(\frac{dt}{ds} \right) \frac{d^2 t}{ds^2} + \frac{d\alpha}{dt} \frac{dt}{ds} \frac{d^3 t}{ds^3} + \alpha' \frac{d^3 t}{ds^3} \\ &= \alpha''' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3} + 2\alpha'' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|} \left(-\frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha''}{|\alpha'|^4} \right) + \alpha' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|} \left(-\frac{\alpha' \cdot \alpha''}{|\alpha'|^4} \right) + \alpha' \left(\frac{d^3 t}{ds^3} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Note: All of these terms, except $\alpha''' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3}$ are zero when dotted with $\beta'(s) \times \beta''(s)$ (since $(u \wedge v) \cdot u = (u \wedge u) \cdot v = 0$)

↑ we do not need calculate this term

Thus $(\beta'(s) \wedge \beta''(s)) \cdot \beta'''(s) = \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3} (\alpha' \wedge \alpha'') \cdot \alpha''' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3}$

$$\begin{aligned} \tau_{\beta}(s) &= -\frac{\beta'(s) \wedge \beta''(s) \cdot \beta'''(s)}{|\beta'(s)|^2} = -\frac{1}{|\alpha'|^5} (\alpha' \wedge \alpha'') \cdot \alpha''' \frac{1}{|\alpha'|^3} \cdot \frac{(|\alpha'|^3)^2}{|\alpha' \wedge \alpha''|^2} \\ &= -\frac{(\alpha' \wedge \alpha'') \cdot \alpha'''}{|\alpha' \wedge \alpha''|^2} \end{aligned}$$

d) Apply the formula in (b) to α , where $\alpha(t) = (x(t), y(t), 0)$

$$\text{then } K = \frac{|\alpha' \wedge \alpha'|}{|\alpha'|^3} = \frac{|x''y' - y''x'|}{((x')^2 + (y')^2)^{3/2}}.$$

the signed curvature is $\pm$ of this value. Since we require that $\{T, n\}$ be a positively oriented basis

$$\text{the determinant } \begin{vmatrix} x' & y' \\ \frac{x''}{K_S} & \frac{y''}{K_S} \end{vmatrix} > 0 \Rightarrow \frac{x'y'' - y''x'}{K_S} > 0$$

$\Rightarrow x'y'' - y''x'$ and K_S have the same sign

$$\Rightarrow K_S = \frac{x'y'' - y''x'}{((x')^2 + (y')^2)^{3/2}}$$

Q.E.D